

GST Provider - Pros, Cons & Recommendation

For the Credit Signal Report (look up a buyer's GSTIN -> filing history, compliance & turnover). Star rating = fit for this project (5 = most recommended).

Provider	Pros	Cons	Rating & Verdict
Karza (Perfios)	Built for lending/underwriting; deep filing history, compliance & turnover signals; trusted by NBFCs	Enterprise sales motion; pricing opaque; can be pricier	★ ★ ★ ★ ★ 5.0 / 5 MOST RECOMMENDED - returns exactly the credit signals our risk model needs.
Clear (ClearTax)	A real GSP; mature GST APIs; good docs; strong GST domain depth	More filing/compliance-oriented than credit-signal-oriented	★ ★ ★ ★ ☆ 4.0 / 5 Strong alternative / backup provider.
Perfios	Enterprise-grade, 99.9% uptime SLA; large client base; owns Karza stack	Geared to bigger clients; pricing on request	★ ★ ★ ★ ☆ 4.0 / 5 Good - same group as Karza; use its credit stack.
Surepass	Cheap, fast plug-and-play; batch processing; 3000+ clients	Thin on filing-history / compliance depth	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆ 3.5 / 5 Best for a cheap pilot; upgrade later for depth.
Signzy	Customisable end-to-end KYB onboarding flows	Heavier than plug-and-play; overkill for simple GSTIN lookups	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆ 3.0 / 5 Only if we want full KYB orchestration.
Others (HyperVerge, Cashfree, Attestr, IDfy, BeFiSc)	Easy, cheap, instant integration	Mostly identity verification; little filing-history depth	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆ 2.5 / 5 Not recommended - too shallow for credit scoring.
Govt GST Portal (GSTN, direct)	Authoritative first-party data; no reseller markup	Needs GSP licence: Rs 2-5 cr capital + GSTN contract; built for filing; months of effort	★ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ 1.0 / 5 NOT recommended for MVP - huge barrier, kills launch speed.

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BEST & PREFERRED: Karza (now part of Perfios)

Karza (Perfios) is the best and preferred choice for the Credit Signal Report because its GST stack is purpose-built for lending and underwriting. Unlike the commodity verifiers that only confirm a GSTIN is valid, Karza returns the exact signals our risk model scores on: filing history (GSTR-1 / GSTR-3B), compliance gaps, cancellation/suspension status and derived turnover. It is widely trusted by NBFCs and lenders, handles the GSTN tunnel for us (no GSP licence or government contract), and gives the deepest credit-relevant data of any option - earning it the full 5/5 fit rating.

Preferred rollout: pilot on Surepass (cheap, fast) to launch quickly, then switch to Karza (Perfios) via a swappable GstProvider interface for production-grade credit signals. Keep Clear (ClearTax) as the backup provider.